ROGER J. EHMPKE

Director of Web Strategy & Digital Experience

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Digital strategy and web experience leader with 25+ years across web development, content systems, accessibility, and institutional technology. Advanced through roles of increasing scope at Kankakee Community College, connecting user needs and institutional priorities with practical architectures, governance, analytics, and team delivery. Experienced leading a lean web team and partnering with IT, Marketing, academic and administrative stakeholders.

SELECTED WORK AND OUTCOMES

- **Public website modernization:** Helped deliver KCC's migration from a SharePoint-based website to a Jekyll / CloudCannon publishing environment with clearer ownership, accessibility standards, and sustainable editorial workflows; the original planning scope included more than 1,200 pages across related properties.
- **MyKCC digital workplace:** Led substantial SharePoint Online information architecture and implementation during the portal replacement launched in May 2023; established an information-sites framework of approximately 16 sites and supported communications workflows used by 22+ contributors.
- **Accessibility governance:** Led development of an institution-wide operating model covering intake, prioritized remediation, vendor accessibility evidence, dashboards, training coordination, and cross-functional accountability; program reporting documents 100+ remediated public pages.
- **Accessible campus wayfinding:** Conceived and built a searchable React / Vite campus map application in approximately three months. Partnered with the web developer on KCC-site integration and incorporated student and stakeholder feedback.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Web Strategy and Digital Experience Nov 2025 - Present

Kankakee Community College | Advancement, Marketing & Public Relations

- Lead institutional web strategy and digital experience, including accessibility governance, CMS and content architecture, UX, analytics, publishing standards, and platform priorities.
- Guide accessibility readiness across websites, documents, forms, media, and third-party systems through shared processes, prioritization, vendor documentation, and leadership reporting.
- Supervise a small web team and coordinate with Marketing, ITS, academic units, administrative departments, and vendors to align practical digital work with institutional needs.
- Designed and built KCC's searchable campus wayfinding application, collaborating with the web developer on integration, testing, and maintenance. Continue serving on KCC's AI Committee, contributing to responsible AI governance, privacy, and human oversight.

Senior Coordinator of Web Design and Development Jul 2023 - Nov 2025

Kankakee Community College

- Guided web development, accessibility, UX, search, and analytics priorities within the Marketing division; collaborated on platform enhancements and departmental needs.
- Initiated the cross-functional accessibility program framework in 2025, defining intake, remediation tracking, vendor-review practices, and reporting structures.
- Helped shape Academic Programs information architecture and student-focused discovery improvements, and supported CMS governance. Served on KCC's AI Taskforce, contributing to recommendations on responsible AI use, privacy, fairness, and institutional adoption.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE - CONTINUED

Coordinator of Web Content and Design Oct 2005 - Jul 2023

Kankakee Community College

- Led design, development, and maintenance of the college's public website through multiple redesigns and CMS transitions, including the COVID-era completion of the Jekyll / CloudCannon migration with the internal web team.
- Played a central implementation role in the 2022-2023 MyKCC replacement. Researched, built, and organized SharePoint Online information sites, governance components, and content migration; helped connect employee resources with Ellucian Experience. **Portal launched May 2023.**
- Collaborated with ITS and department contributors on an Update communications workflow using SharePoint, Power Automate, and connected publishing systems; supported author documentation and adoption.
- Established or improved accessible templates, content standards, user-centered page patterns, analytics reporting, and project tracking; mentored developers and student assistants.

Adjunct Faculty Instructor Jan 2008 - Jun 2013 | Part-time

Kankakee Community College

- Taught web design within the Graphic Design program, covering standards-based HTML/CSS, usability, visual communication, and maintainable production practices.

Web Designer and Developer Aug 2007 - Present | Select freelance projects

River Valley Websites

- Designed and developed websites for community, nonprofit, and small-business clients, balancing usability, content needs, maintainability, and available resources. Freelance work is not the primary professional focus.

Website Manager / Designer / Developer 1998 - Oct 2005

Optimum Nutrition

- Managed the company website and a lean web team, partnering with marketing and product stakeholders on site content, features, brand consistency, and ongoing development.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

Leadership & governance: Digital strategy, web governance, team supervision, stakeholder collaboration, vendor evaluation, accessibility operating models, prioritization and documentation.

Experience & measurement: UX, information architecture, content strategy, accessible publishing, SEO, GA4, Google Tag Manager, Search Console, and performance-informed review.

Platforms & implementation: Jekyll, CloudCannon, GitHub, SharePoint Online, Ellucian Experience, Power Automate, WordPress, HTML/CSS, JavaScript, React/Vite, structured content and CMS workflows.

Emerging practice: AI committee participation, responsible AI adoption, and search / AI discoverability (including AEO and GEO) as part of broader content and governance strategy.

EDUCATION

B.A., Fine Arts (New Media emphasis) - Columbia College Chicago | **A.S., Fine Arts** - Joliet Junior College

SELECTED PROJECT EVIDENCE

Full case studies, decisions, diagrams, and outcomes: rogerehmpke.com/case-studies